Optimising return to play after anterior cruciate ligament reconstruction: 10 crit

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1. Objective Clearance vs Chronological Time

Chronological time alone (>9-12 months) is necessary for biological graft ligamentisation but insufficient for discharge. Safe return to sport requires meeting comprehensive objective neuromuscular, functional, and psychological criteria.

2. The 10 Objective Return-to-Play Criteria

1. Full active knee extension (0 degrees) and symmetrical flexion with zero persistent effusion or joint warmth.
2. Quadriceps strength Limb Symmetry Index (LSI) > 90% (preferably >100% on isokinetic testing).
3. Single-leg hop battery (single hop, triple hop, crossover hop, 6m timed hop) demonstrating LSI > 90%.
4. Qualitative movement assessment: elimination of dynamic knee valgus and trunk collapse on jump landing.
5. Reactive agility and multidirectional deceleration mechanics evaluated under high-speed video recording.
6. High psychological readiness verified via ACL-RSI questionnaire (validated cut-off score > 65).

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